

THE COMPLETE

AI Generalist Roadmap 2026

APRIL EDITION | 5 LEVELS | ZERO CODE | 280+ RESOURCES | ~2 YEARS TO MASTER

108K+

JOBS CUT — Q1 2026

56%

AI SALARY PREMIUM

92%

DEVS USING AI
TOOLS

40%

APPS WITH AI
AGENTS

by **Outskill**

Table of Contents

01	What Is an AI Generalist?	17	Level 5 — Resources & Research Papers
02	Your Evolution Path	18	Spotlight: The Claude Ecosystem in April 2026 NEW
03	The April 2026 AI Landscape	19	The Claude Power Stack: Beyond the Chat Window NEW
04	Key Model Releases — March & April 2026	20	All 5 Levels in Action & First Week Plan
05	The Model Selection Framework	21	30-Day Deep Dive Plan & 2-Year Mastery Timeline
06	The 5 Levels Overview	22	What You'll Achieve as an AI Generalist
07	Level 1 — Foundations: Master the PRD Method	23	The Opportunity — Earning Potential
08	Level 1 — Deep Dive: Running Local LLMs & Model Comparison	24	The Micro-SaaS Formula
09	Level 1 — Resources & Research Papers	25	AI Pricing Cheat Sheet — April 2026
10	Level 2 — Context & Connections: RAG + MCP	26	Complete Tool List by Level
11	Level 2 — Resources & Research Papers	27	Deep Reading List — 100+ Additional Resources
12	Level 3 — Multimodal Creation	28	AI Ethics & Responsible Use
13	Level 3 — Resources & Research Papers	29	What's Coming Next
14	Level 4 — AI Agents & Automation	30	Common Questions — FAQ
15	Level 4 — Resources & Research Papers	31	Recommended Resources & Communities
16	Level 5 — Vibe Coding		

What Is an AI Generalist?

Not a developer. Not a data scientist. An AI Generalist is someone who understands how to use AI tools across every domain — writing, visuals, video, automation, and app building — to solve real problems.

Think of it like this: you don't need to know how a car engine works to be a great driver. You need to know the roads.

The AI Generalist sits at the intersection of creativity, strategy, and technical fluency. They understand how to chain tools together, design prompts that produce professional-grade output, connect AI to real data sources via the Model Context Protocol, build autonomous workflows, and even ship products — all without writing traditional code.

In April 2026, the AI Generalist is the most in-demand skill set in tech. Companies are hiring "AI Operations Lead," "Prompt Engineer," "AI Workflow Architect," and "Automation Specialist" — none of which existed three years ago. The salary premium for AI-literate professionals has reached 56%, and 92% of US developers now use AI coding tools daily.

WHO IS THIS FOR

Anyone who uses a computer for work but doesn't have a technical background. Whether you're a marketer, freelancer, student, manager, or career-switcher — if you can describe a problem clearly, you can become an AI Generalist. No coding required at any level.

HOW TO USE THIS ROADMAP

Start at Level 1 even if you think you're beyond it. Each level builds on the one before. Every level includes tools, a key insight, specific first steps, and curated resources for going deeper. Work through one at a time. Don't skip ahead. This roadmap is designed for a journey of approximately 2 years of dedicated, deliberate practice to go from complete beginner to AI Orchestrator.

What changed since the March edition: Claude Opus 4.7, GPT-5.5 "Spud," DeepSeek V4, native-4K Kling 3.0, and Anthropic's Project Glasswing all shipped in the last 30 days. We've added two new sections covering the Claude ecosystem because it's now the deepest agentic stack a generalist can pick up. The 5-level framework is unchanged — only the tools have moved.

Your Evolution Path

Cook → Chef → Orchestrator

STAGE	WHAT IT MEANS	LEVELS	TIME
Cook	Copy-paste prompts. Follow recipes. Works until it doesn't — then you freeze.	Level 1	1–2 months
Chef	Understand the principles. When something breaks, you adapt because you know <i>why</i> .	Levels 2–3	3–6 months
Orchestrator	Design AI systems with multiple agents. You're the head chef — AI agents are your line cooks.	Levels 4–5	6–18 months

The jump from Cook to Chef is about understanding why certain prompts work. The jump from Chef to Orchestrator is about building systems — connecting multiple AI tools into workflows that run without you.

Most people stay at Cook level forever. They copy prompts from Twitter, get mediocre results, and conclude AI is overhyped. The difference between a Cook and a Chef is about 50–100 hours of deliberate practice. The difference between a Chef and an Orchestrator is about 200–500 hours of building real systems.

The full journey from zero to mastery as an AI Orchestrator takes approximately 2 years of consistent, dedicated focus. This is not a weekend project — it is a career transformation worth every hour. With the new Claude Cowork, agentic Excel/PowerPoint, and Chrome integration shipping in 2026, the Orchestrator level is now reachable for non-technical people in ways it wasn't even six months ago.

"AI will code. Humans will program. Programming is problem solving."

The April 2026 AI Landscape

If February–March 2026 were the most significant months in AI history, April was the consolidation. Claude Opus 4.7, GPT-5.5 "Spud," and DeepSeek V4 all shipped within an eight-day window. Open-source caught up to a margin of error. Anthropic revealed Mythos, a model so capable at security work it isn't being released to the public. The Sora app shutdown turned out to be a permanent retreat — and Kling 3.0 took the 4K crown.

APRIL'S TRIPLE DROP

April 16 — Anthropic shipped Claude Opus 4.7 (1M context, sharper coding, native task budgets, \$5/\$25 per million tokens). April 23 — OpenAI released GPT-5.5 (codename "Spud") to Plus, Pro, Business, and Enterprise users in ChatGPT and Codex. April 24 — DeepSeek dropped V4 in two open-weight variants: V4-Pro (1.6T total / 49B active) and V4-Flash (284B / 13B), both 1M context, MIT-licensed. The era of "one best AI" is over for good — but the catch is that the gap between paid frontier models and free open-weight models is now measured in weeks, not years.

PROJECT GLASSWING & CLAUDE MYTHOS PREVIEW NEW

On April 7, Anthropic announced Claude Mythos Preview — a general-purpose model so capable at finding software vulnerabilities that the company chose not to release it publicly. Mythos found thousands of zero-day vulnerabilities, including one 17-year-old remote code execution bug in FreeBSD. Instead of a public launch, Anthropic launched **Project Glasswing**, giving private access to AWS, Apple, Google, JPMorgan Chase, Microsoft, NVIDIA, the Linux Foundation, Cisco, Broadcom, CrowdStrike, and Palo Alto Networks. Anthropic committed \$100M in usage credits. Pricing for partners: \$25/\$125 per million input/output tokens. OpenAI followed within a week with its own restricted-access cybersecurity model.

SORA APP STAYS DEAD — KLING WINS 4K

OpenAI's consumer Sora app, shut down on March 24, has not returned. Compute that powered Sora is now feeding GPT-5.5. Kling 3.0 launched native 4K video on April 24 (no upscaling — every pixel generated). Veo 3.1 Lite arrived March 31 at \$0.05/second; Veo 3.1 Fast got an aggressive price cut April 7. Synchronized audio-video generation in a single forward pass is now standard in Veo 3.1, Kling 3.0, Sora 2, and Seedance 2.0.

MCP BECOMES UNIVERSAL — AND GETS A SUMMIT

The MCP Dev Summit North America took place April 2–3 at the New York Marriott Marquis with ~1,200 attendees, hosted by the Linux Foundation's Agentic AI Foundation. The protocol now ships with MCP Apps (interactive UIs), the experimental "tasks" primitive for long-running agentic communication, and the new x402 Foundation — also launched April 2. Every major AI lab now has MCP-compatible tooling. A2A (Agent-to-Agent) is fully standardized for inter-agent communication.

Key Model Releases — March & April 2026

MODEL	COMPANY	DATE	KEY BREAKTHROUGH
Claude Opus 4.7 NEW	Anthropic	Apr 16	Most advanced agentic coding; 1M context; high-res vision (3.75MP); task budgets & adaptive thinking
Claude Mythos Preview NEW	Anthropic	Apr 7	Glasswing-only release; cybersecurity-focused; not publicly available
GPT-5.5 "Spud" NEW	OpenAI	Apr 23	"New class of intelligence"; agentic computing; matches GPT-5.4 latency at higher capability
DeepSeek V4 NEW	DeepSeek	Apr 24	1.6T MoE / 49B active; 1M context; CSA+HCA hybrid attention; MIT license
Veo 3.1 Lite	Google	Mar 31	\$0.05/sec for 720p; cheapest tier in Veo 3.1 family
Kling 3.0 (4K) NEW	Kuaishou	Apr 24	Native 4K generation, no upscaling; 10-sec clips in under 2 min
Gemini Deep Research Max NEW	Google	Apr 22	Powered by Gemini 3.1 Pro; 85.9 on BrowseComp; MCP integration
Claude Opus 4.6	Anthropic	Feb 5	Deep reasoning; 200K context (1M beta) — replaced by 4.7
GPT-5.4 (3 variants)	OpenAI	Mar 5	1.05M context; Tool Search; 33% fewer factual errors — now mid-tier
Gemini 3.1 Pro	Google	Feb 19	77.1% ARC-AGI-2; 1M token context; 3-tier thinking
Grok 4.20 Beta 2 / Grok 4.3 Beta	xAI	Mar 3 / Apr	4-agent architecture; 2M context; real-time X data; 4.3 in early beta
NVIDIA Nemotron 3	NVIDIA	Mar 12	60.47% SWE-Bench — highest open-weight coding score
Mistral Small 4 / Qwen 3.5	Mistral / Alibaba	Mar	Open-source frontier reasoning at sub-10B param scales

OTHER MAJOR DEVELOPMENTS

OpenAI claims 900M weekly active ChatGPT users, 50M+ paid subscribers, 9M paying business users, and 4M active Codex users (as of April 23). Anthropic's \$30B Series G valuation now backed by enterprise wins — Bank of New York reports "step-change accuracy" using Opus 4.7 and Mythos. Cursor crossed \$2B ARR; Lovable hit \$200M ARR by end of 2025. ChatGPT in March extended Thinking mode to 256K tokens. Perplexity Deep Research upgraded again. The US Supreme Court declined the Thaler v. Perlmutter appeal in March, confirming AI-generated content is not copyright-eligible. AI now generates ~41% of all code globally; 92% of US developers use AI coding tools daily.

The Model Selection Framework

As an AI Generalist, you need a framework for choosing the right tool for the right job:

USE CASE	BEST MODEL(S) — APRIL 2026	WHY
Deep reasoning & analysis	Claude Opus 4.7	Lowest hallucination rate; verifies own work before reporting
Long-running agentic coding	Claude Opus 4.7 / GPT-5.5 / Claude Code	13% lift over 4.6; SWE-Bench leadership; task budgets
Knowledge-work agents	Claude Cowork (Opus 4.7)	Pulls files, runs apps, ships PowerPoints & Excel models end-to-end
Research with citations	Perplexity Pro / Gemini Deep Research Max	Real-time search; auto-cited; MCP connectors to internal systems
Multimodal (text+image+video)	Gemini 3.1 Pro	Native multimodal; 1M token context; PhD-level reasoning
Creative writing & content	Claude Opus 4.7 / GPT-5.5	Best for tone, style, nuance, and editorial taste
Quick tasks & brainstorming	ChatGPT / Gemini 3 Flash / Claude Haiku 4.5	Fast, cost-effective, more than good enough
Open-source & privacy	DeepSeek V4-Flash / Llama 4 / Qwen 3.5	Free, self-hostable, MIT-licensed weights
Million-token context at low cost	DeepSeek V4-Pro / V4-Flash	27% of V3.2's FLOPs at 1M context, cheapest large model
Google Workspace integration	Gemini 3.1 Pro	Native Drive, Docs, Sheets, Gmail, Personal Intelligence
Real-time X/social data	Grok 4.3 / Grok Voice Agent API	Direct access to X data; sub-1-second voice latency
Budget-conscious teams	DeepSeek V4-Flash / Gemini 3 Flash-Lite	Frontier-class coding at ~\$0.30/MTok or less
On-device / edge	Llama 4 Scout / Qwen 3.5 2B	Runs on consumer GPUs, M-series Macs, and phones
Cybersecurity research	Claude Mythos Preview (Glasswing only)	Saturates known security benchmarks; finds novel zero-days autonomously

The fragmentation is great news for AI Generalists. Instead of one tool, you have specialized lanes. LLM Stats tracked 320+ model releases in Q1 2026, and another 70+ shipped between March and April. The AI Generalist's superpower is knowing which model to use for which task — and routing automatically inside one stack.

The 5 Levels Overview

The AI Generalist Roadmap is structured as five progressive levels. Each builds on the previous and introduces new capabilities, tools, and ways of thinking about AI.

LEVEL 1 — FOUNDATIONS · ~2–3 Months

Master advanced prompting techniques (PRD method, chain-of-thought, persona stacking), experiment with all current frontier models including Opus 4.7 and GPT-5.5, run open-source LLMs locally with Ollama, and fine-tune behavior using OpenAI Playground and the Claude API.

LEVEL 2 — CONTEXT & CONNECTIONS · ~3–4 Months

Integrate connectors using MCP — both online and offline. With 97M+ monthly SDK downloads and the new MCP Apps spec from the April Dev Summit, you can wire any AI to your real data. Design system prompts to power fully autonomous voice agents.

LEVEL 3 — MULTIMODAL CREATION · ~3–4 Months

Learn about Diffusion Models. Build your own AI Clone. Create images, native-4K videos with Kling 3.0, ads, branding material, and full short films — with synchronized audio generated in a single pass.

LEVEL 4 — AI AGENTS & AUTOMATION · ~4–6 Months

Build complex automations and agentic workflows. Use Claude Cowork and Claude in Chrome for desktop and browser automation that runs end-to-end while you focus on other work. Get hands-on with multi-agent systems via CrewAI and n8n.

LEVEL 5 — VIBE CODING · ~4–6 Months

Build a real-world AI product without writing a single line of code. Cursor at \$2B ARR, Lovable at \$200M, and 138+ vibe coding tools now in the market. Ship full-stack apps from a description in an afternoon.

LEVEL 1

Foundations — Master the PRD Method

~2-3 MONTHS • COOK LEVEL

Most people type something vague into ChatGPT, get generic output, and say "AI doesn't work." The problem isn't AI — it's the input. Vague in, vague out.

The PRD Method

COMPONENT	DEFINITION	EXAMPLE
Problem	What exactly are you solving?	I need to land interviews at fintech startups for a PM role
Role	What expert should AI be?	You are a hiring manager at Razorpay who has reviewed 500+ resumes
Deliverable	What output do you want?	Give 5 specific changes with before/after examples for each

The Context Stack

LAYER	WHAT TO INCLUDE	EXAMPLE
History	Past conversations, decisions	"We chose React last quarter because..."
Assets	Files, docs, competitor data	Upload resume, job description, company FAQ
Specifics	Constraints, tone, format	500 words, professional tone, avoid jargon

Advanced Prompting Techniques for April 2026

Chain-of-Thought (CoT): Ask AI to reason step-by-step before giving a final answer. Note: as of Opus 4.7, thinking content is omitted from the response by default — set `display: "summarized"` if you want to see the model's reasoning.

Few-Shot Examples: Provide 2–3 examples of the output format you want. AI mirrors the pattern.

Persona Stacking: Assign multiple expert roles. "You are a senior data analyst *and* a UX designer reviewing this dashboard."

Negative Constraints: Tell AI what NOT to do. "Do not use bullet points. Do not start with 'Sure!'"

Output Scaffolding: Provide the exact structure — XML tags, markdown templates, or JSON schemas to shape the response.

Adaptive Thinking (NEW in Opus 4.7): Replace fixed thinking budgets with adaptive thinking — the model decides how much to think based on the task. For coding and agentic use, set effort to `high` or `xhigh`.

Task Budgets (NEW in Opus 4.7): Give the model a token budget for an entire agentic loop — thinking, tool calls, and outputs. The model sees a countdown and prioritizes work.

LEVEL 1 — Deep Dive: Running Local LLMs

One of the most empowering skills at Level 1 is running open-source models locally. This gives you privacy, unlimited usage, and a deeper understanding of how AI works. With DeepSeek V4-Flash now MIT-licensed and quantizable to run on a single 128GB Apple Silicon laptop, the local-AI ceiling has been raised dramatically.

- **Ollama** — The simplest way to run local models. `ollama run llama3`. Now supports DeepSeek V4-Flash quantizations, Llama 4, Mistral Small 4, and Qwen 3.5.
- **LM Studio** — Beautiful GUI for downloading and chatting with local models. Drag-and-drop simplicity.
- **Jan.ai** — Open-source ChatGPT alternative that runs 100% locally on your machine.
- **Hugging Face** — The GitHub of AI. DeepSeek-V4-Pro (865GB) and V4-Flash (160GB) weights are live; Unsloth quantizations expected within days.

Comparing AI Models — April 2026

MODEL	BEST FOR	PRICE	CONTEXT
ChatGPT (GPT-5.5)	All-rounder, agentic computing, super-app strategy	\$20/mo Plus	1.05M tokens
Claude (Opus 4.7)	Deep reasoning, agentic coding, knowledge work	\$20/mo Pro	1M tokens
Gemini 3.1 Pro	Multimodal, Google integration, Deep Research	\$19.99/mo Pro	1M tokens
Perplexity	Research with citations	\$20/mo Pro	Web-connected
DeepSeek V4-Flash	Frontier reasoning at lowest cost; open weights	API + free weights	1M tokens
DeepSeek V4-Pro	Open-weight frontier flagship	API ~\$0.30/MTok	1M tokens
Grok 4.3 / 4.20 Beta 2	Real-time X data, multi-agent, voice	\$16–30/mo	2M tokens
NotebookLM	Document analysis, podcasts, audio overviews	Free (Google)	50 sources
Llama 4 Scout	Local open-source, multimodal	Free (self-hosted)	10M tokens
Qwen 3.5 2B	On-device, edge AI	Free (Apache 2.0)	128K tokens
Claude Haiku 4.5	Fast, low-cost API tasks	API tier	200K tokens

Level 1 — Resources & Research Papers

Guides & Documentation

Anthropic Prompt Engineering Guide

<https://docs.claude.com/en/docs/build-with-claude/prompt-engineering/overview>

What's New in Claude Opus 4.7

<https://platform.claude.com/docs/en/about-claude/models/whats-new-claude-4-7>

OpenAI GPT-5.5 Introduction

<https://openai.com/index/introducing-gpt-5-5/>

OpenAI Prompt Engineering Best Practices

<https://platform.openai.com/docs/guides/prompt-engineering>

Google Cloud Prompting Strategies

<https://cloud.google.com/vertex-ai/generative-ai/docs/learn/prompts/prompt-design-strategies>

Google's NotebookLM

<https://notebooklm.google.com>

Ollama — Run LLMs Locally

<https://ollama.com>

LM Studio — Local AI Interface

<https://lmstudio.ai>

Hugging Face Open LLM Leaderboard

<https://huggingface.co/spaces/open-llm-leaderboard>

LLM Stats — Real-Time Model Tracker

<https://llm-stats.com>

DeepSeek V4-Pro on Hugging Face

<https://huggingface.co/deepseek-ai/DeepSeek-V4-Pro>

Research Papers

Attention Is All You Need (Transformer Paper)

<https://arxiv.org/abs/1706.03762>

Chain-of-Thought Prompting Elicits Reasoning in LLMs

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2201.11903>

Language Models are Few-Shot Learners (GPT-3)

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2005.14165>

A Systematic Survey of Prompt Engineering in LLMs

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2402.07927>

LoRA: Low-Rank Adaptation of Large Language Models

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2106.09685>

Comprehensive Survey of Hallucination Mitigation

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2401.01313>

DeepSeek-V4 Technical Report (2026)

<https://huggingface.co/deepseek-ai/DeepSeek-V4-Pro>

What is RAG? — IBM

<https://www.ibm.com/topics/retrieval-augmented-generation>

OWASP LLM01:2025 Prompt Injection

<https://genai.owasp.org/llm-top-10-2025/llm01-prompt-injection/>

Sentence Transformers Documentation

<https://www.sbert.net/>

What is Similarity Search? — Pinecone

<https://www.pinecone.io/learn/what-is-similarity-search/>

TOOLS: ChatGPT (GPT-5.5) | Claude (Opus 4.7) | Gemini 3.1 Pro | Perplexity | DeepSeek V4 | NotebookLM | Ollama | LM Studio | Grok 4.3

LEVEL 2

Context & Connections — RAG + MCP

~3-4 MONTHS • CHEF LEVEL

Level 1 teaches you how to talk to AI. Level 2 teaches you how to connect AI to your world. This is where chatbots become assistants — and where the real productivity gains begin.

TECH	WHAT IT IS	REAL-WORLD PROOF
RAG	Retrieval Augmented Generation. Connect AI to YOUR data.	IBM AskHR: 75% ticket reduction, 94% containment
MCP	Model Context Protocol. USB-C for AI. Universal standard.	97M+ monthly SDK downloads. ~1,200 attended April Dev Summit.
A2A	Agent-to-Agent Protocol. HTTP for AI agents.	Created by Google, donated to AAIF. IBM ACP merged in.
MCP Apps NEW	Interactive UI extension to MCP. Servers can render HTML/JS/CSS in sandboxed iframes inside the client.	Spec released Jan 26 2026; biggest reveal at April Dev Summit.
Tasks Primitive NEW	Long-running agentic communication. Servers return a durable handle while real work continues in background.	Experimental in Nov 25 spec; community Triggers WG forming.

Understanding MCP — The USB-C of AI

MCP is the most important infrastructure development in AI since the transformer. In December 2025, MCP was donated to the Agentic AI Foundation (AAIF) under the Linux Foundation, co-founded by Anthropic, Block, and OpenAI. As of April 2026, MCP has 97M+ monthly SDK downloads, 10,000+ active servers, and a thriving developer community that just hosted its largest summit yet. The protocol is now the default integration layer for every major AI lab — including OpenAI, Google DeepMind, AWS Bedrock, and Microsoft Foundry.

What You Can Do With MCP Today

Connect Claude to Google Drive — ask questions about your own documents. Connect to Slack — search messages, summarize channels, draft replies. Connect to Notion — query your wiki, create pages. Connect to Figma — describe design changes. Connect to Gmail and Calendar — manage email and scheduling. Connect to GitHub — review PRs, manage issues. Connect to Asana, Jira, or Linear — manage projects through conversation. Connect to FactSet, MSCI, or PitchBook for live financial data inside Excel via Cowork.

What's New Since March

The April Dev Summit announced **SEP-1442** — the new transport work moving MCP from stateful sessions to stateless requests. **Context bloat** (tool definitions consuming model context) is now solved client-side: Claude Code uses progressive tool discovery and auto-defers tools whose descriptions exceed 10% of context. Anthropic published benchmarks showing ~85% token reduction.

Level 2 — Resources & Research Papers

MCP & Agent Protocols

MCP Official Documentation

<https://modelcontextprotocol.io>

MCP Dev Summit North America 2026

<https://events.linuxfoundation.org/mcp-dev-summit-north-america/>

Claude MCP Connectors Setup

<https://docs.claude.com/en/docs/agents-and-tools/mcp>

MCP GitHub Repository

<https://github.com/modelcontextprotocol>

Agentic AI Foundation (AAIF) Announcement

<https://www.linuxfoundation.org/press/linux-foundation-announces-the-formation-of-the-agentic-ai-foundation>

Anthropic MCP Donation Announcement

<https://www.anthropic.com/news/donating-the-model-context-protocol-and-establishing-of-the-agentic-ai-foundation>

Introducing MCP — Anthropic

<https://www.anthropic.com/news/model-context-protocol>

What is MCP? — IBM

<https://www.ibm.com/topics/model-context-protocol>

Code Execution with MCP — Anthropic

<https://www.anthropic.com/research/code-execution-mcp>

MCP vs A2A Guide — DEV Community

https://dev.to/pockit_tools/mcp-vs-a2a-the-complete-guide-to-ai-agent-protocols-in-2026-30li

RAG & Vector Infrastructure

Pinecone — Vector Database for RAG

<https://pinecone.io>

LlamaIndex — Build RAG Applications

<https://llamaindex.ai>

LangChain — LLM Application Framework

<https://langchain.com>

Function Calling with LLMs

<https://www.promptingguide.ai/capabilities/function-calling>

Voice Agents

ElevenLabs Conversational AI

<https://elevenlabs.io/conversational-ai>

Voice AI Agents — ElevenLabs

<https://elevenlabs.io/voice-agents>

Voice AI Agents — Deepgram

<https://deepgram.com/learn/voice-ai-agents-everything-you-need-to-know>

Grok Voice Agent API (xAI)

<https://x.ai/news>

OpenAI Whisper — Speech to Text

<https://github.com/openai/whisper>

Multi-Turn Conversations — OpenAI

<https://platform.openai.com/docs/guides/conversation-state>

TOOLS: Claude + MCP | Slack | Notion | Google Drive | Figma | Canva | Gmail | Asana | Pinecone | LangChain

LEVEL 3

Multimodal Creation — One-Person Agency

~3-4 MONTHS • CHEF LEVEL

One AI Generalist can now produce content that used to require an entire agency. This isn't about pretty pictures — it's production pipelines at scale. As of April 2026, four major video models generate synchronized audio in a single pass, and Kling 3.0 ships native 4K from a text prompt.

2026 Breakthrough Stack — April Edition

MEDIUM	TOOLS	2026 BREAKTHROUGH
Images	Midjourney, Ideogram, GPT Image 2.0, Flux, Nano Banana 2	Character consistency solved — same face across every image
Video	Kling 3.0 (native 4K), Veo 3.1 / Lite / Fast, Runway Gen-4.5, Seedance 2.0	4K multi-shot with native audio in one pass. Kling tops Elo.
Audio	ElevenLabs, Suno, Udio	Voice cloning production-ready. Full music production by AI.
3D	World Labs Marble, Runway GWM-1	Interactive world models. Real-time 3D from text.
Music	Lyria 3 Pro (Google), Suno, Udio	Tracks up to 3 min with granular control via Gemini API

The Sora Aftermath — Kling Wins April

OpenAI's consumer Sora app, shut down March 24, has not returned. The compute moved to GPT-5.5. Kling 3.0 launched native 4K on April 24 — every pixel generated from text, no upscaling. Veo 3.1 Lite at \$0.05/sec became the cheapest broadcast-grade tier on March 31. Veo 3.1 Fast got an aggressive April 7 price cut. The April leaderboard shifted: Alibaba's HappyHorse-1.0 hit Elo 1,357, with Seedance 2.0 second at 1,273, and Kling 3.0 Pro #1 in the Kling family. **The lesson:** build on platforms with sustainable economics — not on any single shiny demo.

The AI Content Production Pipeline

Step 1 — Strategy: Claude Opus 4.7 analyzes product, defines audience, generates campaign brief. **Step 2 — Copy:** Generate ad copy, email sequences, social posts with Claude or GPT-5.5. **Step 3 — Images:** Product mockups and social graphics with Midjourney or Flux. **Step 4 — Video:** 15–30 second video ads using Kling 3.0 (4K) or Veo 3.1. **Step 5 — Audio:** Voiceover with ElevenLabs. Clone your brand voice for consistency. **Step 6 — Music:** Background music with Suno, Udio, or Google Lyria 3 Pro. **Step 7 — Distribution:** Schedule and post via Cowork's scheduled tasks across LinkedIn, Instagram, X, and YouTube.

Level 3 — Resources & Research Papers

Generation Tools

Midjourney Documentation

<https://docs.midjourney.com>

Kling AI 3.0 — Video Generation (Native 4K)

<https://klingai.com>

ElevenLabs — Voice Cloning & TTS

<https://elevenlabs.io>

Suno — AI Music Generation

<https://suno.com>

Runway ML — Creative AI Suite (Gen-4.5)

<https://runwayml.com>

Google Veo 3.1

<https://deepmind.google/technologies/veo>

Veo 3.1 Lite Pricing & Free Access (April 2026)

<https://www.veo3ai.io/blog/veo-3-1-lite-pricing-guide-2026>

Ideogram — AI Image Generation

<https://ideogram.ai>

Seedance 2.0 (ByteDance)

<https://www.jimeng.com>

Research Papers & Reference

Denoising Diffusion Probabilistic Models

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2006.11239>

High-Resolution Image Synthesis with Latent Diffusion

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2112.10752>

Text-to-Image Diffusion Models Survey

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2303.07909>

Adding Conditional Control (ControlNet)

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2302.05543>

ControlNet GitHub Repository

<https://github.com/lllyasviel/ControlNet>

Stable Diffusion Guide — Hugging Face

https://huggingface.co/docs/diffusers/stable_diffusion

Runway Gen-4 Introduction

<https://runwayml.com/blog/introducing-runway-gen-4/>

Inpainting and Outpainting

<https://machinelearningmastery.com/inpainting-and-outpainting-with-stable-diffusion/>

Best AI Video Generators 2026 — Comparison

<https://aimlapi.com/blog/best-ai-video-generators-2026-veo-3-1-kling-sora-2-seedance-more-compared>

TOOLS: Kling 3.0 | Veo 3.1 | Midjourney | ElevenLabs | Suno | Runway Gen-4.5 | Flux | Ideogram | Seedance 2.0

LEVEL 4

AI Agents & Automation

~4-6 MONTHS • ORCHESTRATOR LEVEL

A chatbot waits for you to type. An agent goes and DOES things — proactively, autonomously. Even after your laptop shuts down. With Claude Cowork generally available on macOS and Windows since April, the agent revolution is no longer for developers only.

40%

ENTERPRISE APPS WITH AI AGENTS BY EOY 2026

97M+

MONTHLY MCP SDK DOWNLOADS

85%

ENTERPRISES IMPLEMENTING AI AGENTS BY 2025

Chatbot vs. AI Agent

CHATBOT	AI AGENT
Waits for your input	Acts proactively on triggers and schedules
Answers questions	Completes multi-step tasks end-to-end
Single conversation	Runs continuously in background
No tool access	Uses tools: email, calendar, APIs via MCP
Forgets between sessions	Maintains state and memory
You do the work	It does the work, you oversee

Automation Platforms Compared — April 2026

PLATFORM	BEST FOR	PRICING	AI INTEGRATION
Claude Cowork NEW	Non-coding knowledge work, desktop automation	Pro/Max plan	Native Opus 4.7, Chrome, Excel, PPT, MCP
n8n	Technical users, self-hosted	Free / \$24 cloud	Native OpenAI, Anthropic nodes
Make.com	Visual workflow design	Free / \$10.59 Core	HTTP modules for any AI API
Zapier	Simplicity, 7,000+ apps	Free / \$29.99 Pro	Built-in ChatGPT + AI actions
Lindy AI	Personal AI assistants	Free / \$49.99	GPT-5 + Claude routing
CrewAI	Multi-agent frameworks (developer)	Open source	Any LLM provider

Level 4 — Resources & Research Papers

Automation Platforms

Claude Cowork (Anthropic)

<https://claude.com/product/cowork>

Claude for Chrome

<https://claude.com/claude-for-chrome>

n8n — Open Source Workflow Automation

<https://n8n.io>

Make.com — Visual Automation

<https://make.com>

Zapier — Connect Your Apps

<https://zapier.com>

Claude Computer Use Docs

<https://docs.claude.com/en/docs/agents-and-tools/computer-use>

CrewAI — Multi-Agent Framework

<https://www.crewai.com>

Lindy AI — Personal AI Assistant

<https://lindy.ai>

Foundational Reading

Building Effective Agents — Anthropic

<https://www.anthropic.com/research/building-effective-agents>

What is a Multi-Agent System? — IBM

<https://www.ibm.com/topics/multi-agent-system>

What is AI Agent Orchestration? — IBM

<https://www.ibm.com/topics/ai-agent-orchestration>

LangChain Documentation

<https://docs.langchain.com>

LangChain Academy — Free Courses

<https://academy.langchain.com>

CrewAI GitHub Repository

<https://github.com/joaoimdmoura/crewAI>

n8n Beginner's Guide — FreeCodeCamp

<https://www.freecodecamp.org/news/a-beginners-guide-to-automation-with-n8n/>

What is RPA? — IBM

<https://www.ibm.com/topics/rpa>

AAIF MCP Summit Recap — InfoQ

<https://www.infoq.com/news/2026/04/aaif-mcp-summit/>

Anthropic — Claude Cowork Knowledge Work

<https://claude.com/product/cowork>

TOOLS: Claude Cowork | Claude Chrome | n8n | Make.com | Zapier | Relevance AI | Lindy | CrewAI

LEVEL 5

Vibe Coding — Build Without Code

~4-6 MONTHS • ORCHESTRATOR LEVEL

Describe what you want in plain English. AI writes the code. You guide, test, iterate. Building products is no longer just for developers. By April 2026, there are 138+ vibe coding tools on the market, and the category has split into seven sub-categories.

92%

US DEVS USE AI CODING TOOLS
DAILY

41%

OF ALL CODE IS AI-GENERATED

\$2B

CURSORS ARR BY EARLY 2026

The Vibe Coding Stack — April 2026

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	PRICE
Cursor	AI-native code editor (now \$2B ARR)	Full-stack apps for devs	\$20/mo Pro
Bolt.new	Full-stack from text prompt; Bolt Cloud since Aug 2025	MVPs, prototypes	Free tier
Lovable.dev	Beautiful apps from description (\$200M ARR)	SaaS apps, dashboards	\$25/mo Pro
Replit	Browser-based IDE with AI	Quick prototypes	Free tier
OpenAI Codex	Autonomous coding agent (now powered by GPT-5.5)	Large codebases	ChatGPT Pro
Claude Code	Terminal-based agentic coding (now Opus 4.7)	Backend, APIs, multi-repo	Claude Pro
v0 (Vercel)	Best shadcn component generator	Frontend, components	Free / \$20
Windsurf	AI-native IDE (Codeium)	Pro-engineering workflows	\$15/mo
Kiro	Spec-driven development	Test coverage, traceability	Variable

How To Vibe Code — Step By Step

Step 1: Write a clear product description. Be specific about features, design, user flow. **Step 2:** Paste into Bolt.new, Lovable, or Cursor. Let AI build V1. **Step 3:** Iterate visually. "Make header bigger." "Add dark mode." "Validate email." **Step 4:** Test and fix — describe bugs, AI fixes them. Watch out for the "fix and break" cycle. **Step 5:** Deploy — most tools include one-click deployment via Vercel or Cloudflare. **Step 6:** Connect Stripe, add analytics, start charging users.

Level 5 — Resources & Research Papers

Vibe Coding Tools

Cursor — AI Code Editor

<https://cursor.com>

Bolt.new — Build Full-Stack Apps

<https://bolt.new>

Lovable.dev — AI App Builder

<https://lovable.dev>

Replit — Browser IDE with AI

<https://replit.com>

v0 (Vercel) — Component Generator

<https://v0.dev>

Windsurf — AI-native IDE

<https://codeium.com/windsurf>

Claude Code Documentation

<https://docs.claude.com/en/docs/agents-and-tools/claude-code>

GitHub Copilot

<https://github.com/features/copilot>

Hosting & Backend

Vercel — Deploy Apps

<https://vercel.com>

Supabase — Backend as a Service

<https://supabase.com>

Firebase — App Development Platform

<https://firebase.google.com>

Google AppSheet — No-Code Apps

<https://cloud.google.com/appsheet>

Foundational Reading

Low-Code vs No-Code — IBM

<https://www.ibm.com/blog/low-code-vs-no-code/>

No-Code AI for Beginners

<https://launchlemonade.app/blog/no-code-ai-for-beginners>

Vibe Coding Tools Compared (April 2026)

<https://till-freitag.com/en/blog/vibe-coding-tools-comparison>

Cursor vs Bolt vs Lovable Showdown

<https://lovable.dev/guides/cursor-vs-bolt-vs-lovable-comparison>

15 Best Vibe Coding Tools (2026)

<https://www.index.dev/blog/vibe-coding-tools>

10 Best Vibe Coding Tools — Roadmap.sh

<https://roadmap.sh/vibe-coding/best-tools>

TOOLS: Cursor | Bolt | Lovable | Replit | v0 | Windsurf | Codex | Claude Code | Code Rabbit | Copilot

Spotlight: The Claude Ecosystem

In the last 90 days, Anthropic has shipped more shipped products than any other AI lab. The Claude ecosystem now spans coding, browser, desktop, Office, and security — making it the deepest agentic stack any non-developer can pick up today. Here's the complete map as of April 2026.

Models

MODEL	STATUS	WHAT IT'S FOR
Claude Opus 4.7 NEW	GA · Apr 16	Most capable generally available model. 1M context, 128K output, adaptive thinking, task budgets. High-res vision (3.75MP).
Claude Sonnet 4.6	GA	Fast mid-tier; near-Opus performance at Sonnet pricing
Claude Haiku 4.5	GA	Fastest, lowest-cost — for high-volume tasks
Claude Mythos Preview NEW	Glasswing only · Apr 7	Most powerful Claude model. Restricted to ~52 partners. Cybersecurity research.

What's New in Opus 4.7

Same price as 4.6: \$5/\$25 per million input/output tokens, with 90% prompt-cache savings and 50% batch savings. **1M context standard.** **Task budgets:** Tell Claude how many tokens to spend across an entire agentic loop. **Adaptive thinking:** Replaces fixed thinking budgets — model decides reasoning depth on its own. New xhigh effort level for hardest problems. **High-resolution vision:** 2576px / 3.75MP (up from 1.15MP). **New tokenizer:** Up to 1.35× more tokens per text — verify your costs at scale. **Caveat:** Some users have reported Opus 4.7 follows instructions more literally than 4.6, which can feel like a regression for ambiguous prompts. Anthropic confirms 4.7 will not "infer requests you didn't make."

Project Glasswing & Mythos Preview

On April 7, Anthropic launched Project Glasswing, an initiative to secure the world's most critical software. Mythos Preview — Anthropic's most powerful model — is being used by AWS, Apple, Broadcom, Cisco, CrowdStrike, Google, JPMorgan Chase, Linux Foundation, Microsoft, NVIDIA, and Palo Alto Networks plus ~40 additional infrastructure partners. Mythos has already found thousands of zero-day vulnerabilities, including a 17-year-old FreeBSD RCE bug (CVE-2026-4747) that gave attackers root via NFS. Anthropic committed \$100M in usage credits and \$4M in donations to open-source security organizations. Pricing for partners is \$25/\$125 per million tokens. Mythos will not be made generally available, but Anthropic plans to deploy "Mythos-class" capabilities to all users once safeguards mature — Opus 4.7 is the first model to ship those new safeguards.

Why This Matters for Generalists

The window for becoming dangerous-good with one model is closing. Claude is now embedded in the OS-level surface (Office, Chrome, Desktop), the developer surface (Code, Cowork), and the API surface — meaning you can pick one ecosystem and go very deep, instead of wiring six tools together. The next section lays out the full power stack.

The Claude Power Stack: Beyond the Chat Window

Claude is no longer just a chat tab. As of April 2026, it ships across nine surfaces, each with its own job. Here's the full stack — and how an AI Generalist should sequence learning across it.

SURFACE	BEST FOR	WHAT IT DOES
Claude.ai (web/mobile/desktop)	Daily driver	Chat, projects, artifacts, custom skills, interactive apps in mobile chat
Claude Cowork NEW GA	Knowledge work	Desktop agent — pulls files, runs apps, ships PowerPoints & Excel models. GA on macOS & Windows. Pro/Max plans.
Claude Code	Coding	Terminal-based agentic coding. Background tasks. Multi-file refactors. Works with VS Code, JetBrains, Slack.
Claude in Chrome	Browser tasks	Browses, extracts, fills forms. Pairs with Cowork for research-to-deck pipelines.
Claude in Excel	Spreadsheets	Reads workbooks, traces formulas, edits pivots/conditional formatting. All Pro plans since Jan 24.
Claude in PowerPoint	Decks	Reads template, generates on-brand slides. Max/Team/Enterprise plans.
Claude for Word NEW APR	Documents	Review, redline, draft. Edits appear as native tracked changes. Completes the Office suite.
Claude in Slack	Team chat	Search messages, summarize threads, draft replies, channel context.
Claude API + Skills	Builders	Programmable Claude. Skills are shareable workflow packages — install one, get slash-commands + connectors + tools bundled.

Shared Context — The Real Breakthrough

Since the March 2026 update, Claude maintains **Shared Context** across Excel, PowerPoint, and Word. Conversation history, data references, and analysis from one app are automatically available in the others. Run a variance analysis in Excel, switch to PowerPoint — the chart and commentary are ready. No re-explaining. No copy-paste. This is the architectural breakthrough that single-app assistants like Microsoft Copilot can't replicate.

Cowork + Chrome: The Research-to-Deliverable Loop

Claude in Chrome visits competitor sites and pulls pricing, features, and positioning. Cowork compiles everything into a formatted PowerPoint, ready for your strategy meeting. Or: Claude reads your calendar, matches attendees to Salesforce contacts, and drafts activity logs. You add notes and approve. Or: Claude scans your inbox, identifies marketing emails, presents them as a list for bulk deletion review. None of this requires a developer.

Recommended Sequence for Generalists

Week 1: Master Claude.ai with Projects and the PRD method. **Week 2:** Connect Google Drive and Slack via MCP. **Week 3:** Install Claude in Excel and PowerPoint. Use Shared Context. **Week 4:** Activate Cowork on your desktop. Schedule one weekly task. **Week 5:** Add Claude in Chrome. Build a research-to-deck pipeline. **Week 6+:** Build your first custom Skill or plugin and share it with your team.

Pricing as of April 2026: Claude Pro at \$20/mo unlocks Excel/Word/Cowork (research preview). Claude Max at \$100/mo adds PowerPoint and full Cowork analytics. Self-serve Enterprise plans are now available without sales calls — single seat type with Claude + Code + Cowork bundled.

All 5 Levels in Action — The AI Executive Assistant

LVL	CAPABILITY	WHAT IT DOES
1	Foundations	Prompting tuned to your communication style — tone, vocabulary, formality
2	Context	Connected to Calendar, Slack, Email, Drive via MCP — accesses real data in real time
3	Multimodal	Auto-generates branded presentations, social posts, thumbnails, and 4K video on demand
4	Agents	Triage inbox 24/7, categorizes by priority, drafts context-aware replies via Cowork & Chrome
5	Vibe Code	Custom dashboard you built that ties all the above into one interface

Your First Week Plan

DAY	DO THIS	YOU'LL LEARN
Day 1–2	Use the PRD Method on 5 different problems with Claude Opus 4.7 and GPT-5.5	How specificity transforms output
Day 3–4	Connect Claude to Google Drive and Slack via MCP	The chatbot-to-assistant power gap
Day 5	Generate one image (Midjourney) + one 8-sec video (Kling 3.0)	Multimodal creation acceleration
Day 6	Activate Cowork. Schedule one weekly automation in n8n or Cowork	Why agents are the future
Day 7	Build a landing page on Bolt.new or Lovable	Vibe coding turns ideas into products

By Day 7, you've touched all 5 levels. You're no longer a Cook — you're already thinking like a Chef.

30-Day Deep Dive Plan & 2-Year Mastery Timeline

30-Day Deep Dive Plan

WEEK	FOCUS	DAILY ACTIVITIES	GOAL
Week 1	Level 1 Foundations	PRD practice. Try 4 frontier models (Opus 4.7, GPT-5.5, Gemini 3.1, DeepSeek V4-Flash). Run one local model.	High-quality outputs on demand
Week 2	Level 2 Context	Set up MCP. Build NotebookLM project. System prompts. Activate Cowork.	AI connected to real data
Week 3	Level 3 Multimodal	Create images daily. Make 3 videos (Kling 3.0). Clone your voice in ElevenLabs.	Content production pipeline
Week 4	Level 4–5 Agents + Code	Build 3 automations. Ship one Lovable app. Custom Cowork plugin.	Working AI system
Days 29–30	Portfolio	Document builds. Create portfolio. Reach out to 5 clients.	Ready to monetize

The 2-Year Mastery Timeline

Becoming a true AI Orchestrator takes approximately 2 years of dedicated practice:

PERIOD	FOCUS	WHAT YOU'LL MASTER	OUTCOME
Months 1–3	Level 1	Prompting, model selection, local LLMs, context	10× your output quality
Months 4–7	Level 2	MCP integrations, RAG systems, voice agents, Shared Context	AI connected to all tools
Months 8–11	Level 3	Image/video/audio generation, AI clones, native-4K pipelines	One-person agency
Months 12–17	Level 4	n8n / Cowork / CrewAI / Make automations, multi-agent systems	Autonomous systems 24/7
Months 18–24	Level 5	Vibe coding, shipping products, Micro-SaaS	Revenue-generating products

"The best thing you can do is show someone the path forward."

What You'll Achieve as an AI Generalist

After Level 1 — Foundations

You will get consistently high-quality outputs from any AI model. You will know how to write prompts that produce professional-grade results. You will understand the strengths of every major model — Opus 4.7, GPT-5.5, Gemini 3.1 Pro, DeepSeek V4 — and know when to use each. You will run open-source models locally for privacy and unlimited usage.

After Level 2 — Context

You will have AI connected to your real-world data and tools through MCP. Your AI assistant will search your Drive, read Slack, check calendar, and pull database data. You will build custom knowledge bases with RAG and deploy voice agents. You'll understand MCP Apps, the tasks primitive, and how to wire interactive UI extensions into your workflows.

After Level 3 — Multimodal

You will be a one-person content agency. You will generate professional images, native-4K video with synchronized audio, voiceovers, and music from text. You will have built your own AI clone with voice replica and consistent visual identity.

After Level 4 — Agents

You will have autonomous systems running 24/7. Inbox triaged automatically by Cowork. Leads captured and routed via n8n. Content repurposed across platforms. Browser tasks done by Claude in Chrome. Excel models built and updated overnight. You will design and manage multi-agent systems.

After Level 5 — Vibe Coding

You will build and ship real software products without writing code. Landing pages, dashboards, SaaS apps, internal tools — deployed and generating revenue. You'll know when to use Lovable vs Cursor vs Bolt vs Claude Code.

The Compounding Effect

The real power is the combination. When you can prompt expertly (L1), connect to real data (L2), create multimedia (L3), automate workflows (L4), and build tools (L5), you become exponentially more valuable. This is why the full journey takes ~2 years and why it's worth every hour: you're building a career moat that compounds over time.

The Opportunity

The gap between what's possible with AI and what the market knows how to do — that's your arbitrage window. It's still wide open in April 2026.

BUILD FOR CLIENTS	BUILD FOR YOURSELF	BUILD FOR COMPANIES
Automation agencies	Micro-SaaS products	MCP integrations
AI consulting & audits	AI creative services	RAG-powered search
Workflow optimization	Content at scale	AI agent design
Voice agent deployment	Courses & coaching	Cowork & Skills development

Earning Potential by Level

LEVEL	SKILL	SERVICE	PRICE RANGE
Level 1–2	Prompting + Context	AI consulting, prompt libraries	\$500–\$2,000 / audit
Level 3	Multimodal Creation	Content packages, brand assets	\$1,000–\$5,000 / project
Level 4	Automation	Workflow builds, agent setup	\$2,000–\$10,000 / system
Level 5	Vibe Coding	App development, SaaS MVPs	\$2,000–\$15,000 / product
All Levels	Full AI Generalist	Retainer / full-time role	\$5K–\$15K / month

The Micro-SaaS Formula

STEP 1 — Find the Pain: Go to Reddit, Twitter/X, niche communities. Find complaints. r/SaaS, r/Entrepreneur are goldmines.

STEP 2 — Validate Before Building: Post: "Would you pay \$X/month for Y?" Get 10+ positive responses.

STEP 3 — Build the MVP in a Weekend: Use Bolt.new or Lovable. ONE core feature. Connect Stripe. Deploy. Cost: \$0–\$50.

STEP 4 — Launch and Iterate: Share where you found the problem. Launch discount. First 10 customers = product managers.

STEP 5 — Scale with AI: Cowork handles support. AI content for marketing. Claude Code ships features faster.

AI Pricing Cheat Sheet — April 2026

PRODUCT	FREE TIER	PRO PRICE	BEST VALUE?
ChatGPT (GPT-5.5)	Yes (GPT-5.4 limited)	\$20/mo Plus	Best all-rounder; agentic computing
Claude (Opus 4.7)	Yes (Sonnet limited)	\$20/mo Pro	Best for reasoning & agentic coding
Claude Max	—	\$100/mo	Adds full Cowork + PowerPoint
Gemini 3.1 Pro	Yes (Flash)	\$19.99/mo Pro	Best Google integration; Deep Research Max
Perplexity	Yes (limited)	\$20/mo Pro	Best for research with citations
DeepSeek V4	Yes (chat.deepseek.com)	API ~\$0.30/MTok	Best free / lowest-cost frontier option
Grok 4.3 / SuperGrok	Via X	\$16/mo Premium+	Best for X/social data + voice agents
NotebookLM	Yes (full features)	Free	Best free RAG tool
n8n	Self-hosted free	\$24/mo cloud	Best open automation
Cursor	Limited free	\$20/mo Pro	Best AI code editor (\$2B ARR)
Lovable	Free tier	\$25/mo Pro	Best for non-coders building apps
Bolt.new	Free tier	Pay-as-you-go	Best browser-native MVP builder
Kling 3.0	Limited	~\$6.99/mo	Cheapest native 4K video
Veo 3.1 Lite	\$300 GCP credit	\$0.05/sec	Cheapest Veo tier
ElevenLabs	10K chars/mo	\$22/mo Creator	Best voice cloning

Complete Tool List by Level

LEVEL	FOCUS	RECOMMENDED TOOLS
Level 1	Foundations	ChatGPT (GPT-5.5), Claude (Opus 4.7), Gemini 3.1, Perplexity, DeepSeek V4, NotebookLM, Ollama, LM Studio, Grok 4.3
Level 2	Context	Claude + MCP, Slack, Notion, Google Drive, Figma, Canva, Gmail, Asana, Pinecone, LangChain, ElevenLabs
Level 3	Multimodal	Midjourney, Ideogram, Kling 3.0, Veo 3.1, Runway Gen-4.5, ElevenLabs, Suno, Flux, Seedance 2.0
Level 4	Agents	Claude Cowork, Claude Chrome, n8n, Make.com, Zapier, Relevance AI, Lindy, CrewAI
Level 5	Vibe Coding	Cursor, Bolt.new, Lovable, Replit, v0, Windsurf, OpenAI Codex, Claude Code, Code Rabbit, Copilot

Deep Reading List — 100+ Additional Resources

All links verified as of April 2026. Organized by topic.

Transformer Architecture & Fundamentals

Attention Is All You Need (NeurIPS)

<https://papers.neurips.cc/paper/7181-attention-is-all-you-need>

How Transformers Work — DataCamp

<https://www.datacamp.com/tutorial/how-transformers-work>

GPT Decoder-Only Architecture Explained

<https://cameronrwolfe.substack.com/p/decoder-only-transformers>

BERT Architecture — Wikipedia

[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/BERT_\(language_model\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/BERT_(language_model))

Masked Language Models — IBM

<https://www.ibm.com/topics/masked-language-models>

Sentence Transformers — Hugging Face

<https://huggingface.co/sentence-transformers>

Top LLM Benchmarks: MMLU, HellaSwag, BBH

<https://www.confident-ai.com/blog/llm-benchmarks-mmlu-hellaswag-bbh>

30 LLM Evaluation Benchmarks

<https://www.evidentlyai.com/ranking-llm/llm-benchmarks>

What Are LLM Benchmarks? — IBM

<https://www.ibm.com/topics/llm-benchmarks>

Vector Database — Wikipedia

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Vector_database

Fine-Tuning & Model Optimization

LoRA Fine-Tuning Guide — Databricks

<https://www.databricks.com/blog/efficient-fine-tuning-lora-guide-llms>

Fine-tuning LLMs for Domain Adaptation — Nature

<https://www.nature.com/articles/s41598-024-70747-w>

Model Compression Techniques Survey

<https://unify.ai/model-compression-survey-techniques-tools-libraries>

Running LLMs Locally with llama.cpp

<https://steelphoenix.github.io/posts/llama-cpp-guide/>

llama.cpp GitHub Repository

<https://github.com/ggerganov/llama.cpp>

Run LLMs Locally: 7 Methods — DataCamp

<https://www.datacamp.com/tutorial/run-llms-locally>

In-Context Learning — IBM Research

<https://research.ibm.com/blog/in-context-learning>

A Survey on In-context Learning

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2301.00234>

Instruction Tuning for LLMs: A Survey

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2308.10792>

Understanding OpenAI Temperature

<https://coltsteele.com/tips/understanding-openai-temperature-parameter>

DeepSeek V4 Architecture (CSA + HCA)

<https://api-docs.deepseek.com/news/news260424>

Deep Reading List (continued)

MCP, Function Calling & Voice Agents

Introduction to MCP Course — Anthropic

<https://anthropic.skilljar.com/series/introduction-to-model-context-protocol>

AAIF MCP Summit Recap (April 2026) — InfoQ

<https://www.infoq.com/news/2026/04/aaif-mcp-summit/>

Function Calling — Hugging Face

https://huggingface.co/docs/tgi/messages_api#function-calling

Function Calling — Martin Fowler

<https://martinfowler.com/articles/function-calling-llm.html>

Integrating Real-Time AI Chatbots — VideoSDK

<https://www.videosdk.live/blog/conversational-ai-api>

Speech and Voice Agents — AWS

<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/prescriptive-guidance/latest/voice-agents-chatbots/speech-voice-agents.html>

Voice AI Agents — Picovoice

<https://picovoice.ai/blog/how-do-voice-ai-agents-work/>

Agent Orchestration Platforms — Speechmatics

<https://www.speechmatics.com/blog/ai-agent-orchestration-platforms>

Whisper Large v3 — Hugging Face

<https://huggingface.co/openai/whisper-large-v3>

Conversational AI Design — Botpress

<https://botpress.com/blog/conversational-ai-design>

MCP vs A2A Guide

https://dev.to/pockit_tools/mcp-vs-a2a-the-complete-guide-to-ai-agent-protocols-in-2026-30li

Image Generation & Diffusion Models

Latent Diffusion Models Paper

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2112.10752>

In-Depth Guide to DDPM — LearnOpenCV

<https://learnopencv.com/denoising-diffusion-probabilistic-models/>

Diffusion Pipelines — Hugging Face

<https://huggingface.co/docs/diffusers/api/pipelines/ddpm>

Research Papers on Diffusion Models

<https://www.appliedaibook.com/research-papers-on-diffusion-models/>

ControlNet — Hugging Face

<https://huggingface.co/docs/diffusers/using-diffusers/controlnet>

Stable Diffusion GitHub

<https://github.com/CompVis/stable-diffusion>

Midjourney vs DALL-E — Zapier

<https://zapier.com/blog/midjourney-vs-chatgpt/>

What is Inpainting? — Adobe

<https://www.adobe.com/products/photoshop/discover/inpainting.html>

Text to Image Generation Survey

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.02527>

AI Agents & Multi-Agent Systems

What is CrewAI? — IBM

<https://www.ibm.com/topics/crewai>

Multi-Agent Systems with CrewAI — DeepLearning.AI

<https://www.deeplearning.ai/short-courses/multi-ai-agent-systems-with-crewai/>

Build LLM Apps with LangChain — DataCamp

<https://www.datacamp.com/tutorial/how-to-build-llm-applications-with-langchain>

Workflow Automation — Zapier

<https://zapier.com/blog/workflow-automation/>

Agentic Orchestration — UiPath

<https://www.uipath.com/automation/agentic-orchestration>

What is RPA? — SAP

<https://www.sap.com/products/financial-management/what-is-robotic-process-automation.html>

Multi-Agent System — Wikipedia

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Multi-agent_system

Agentic Workflows vs Agents — Orkes

<https://orkes.io/content/blog/agentic-ai-workflows-vs-agents>

No-Code, Vibe Coding & Video Tools

Google AppSheet — No-Code

<https://www.appsheet.com>

Low-Code vs No-Code — Microsoft

<https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/power-platform/low-code-vs-no-code>

No-Code AI Tools — BuildFire

<https://buildfire.com/no-code-ai-tools/>

Build AI Agents Without Coding

<https://ampcome.com/blog/how-to-build-ai-agents-without-coding>

No Code AI Case Studies

<https://digitaldefynd.com/no-code-ai-case-studies/>

AI Adoption Case Studies

<https://www.ninetwothree.co/blog/ai-adoption-case-studies>

Runway Gen-4

<https://runwayml.com/blog/introducing-runway-gen-4/>

What are Deepfakes? — Fortinet

<https://www.fortinet.com/resources/cyberglossary/deepfake>

Securing LLMs — NVIDIA

<https://developer.nvidia.com/blog/securing-llm-systems-against-prompt-injection/>

Prompt Injection — IBM

<https://www.ibm.com/topics/prompt-injection>

Project Glasswing — Anthropic

<https://www.anthropic.com/glasswing>

AI Ethics & Responsible Use

Being an AI Generalist means understanding not just what AI can do, but what it should do. The April 2026 Mythos disclosure reset the conversation about responsible release.

Key Principles

Always verify critical outputs. AI can hallucinate. Never blindly trust for medical, legal, or financial decisions. Even Opus 4.7's improved hallucination resistance — which Bank of New York's CIO calls a "step change" — is not zero.

Disclose AI-generated content. Be transparent about AI involvement. Trust is your most valuable asset.

Respect intellectual property. The US Supreme Court declined the Thaler v. Perlmutter appeal in March 2026, confirming AI-generated content is not copyright-eligible. Check each tool's license terms before using AI output commercially.

Understand bias. Review outputs for potential bias in high-stakes decisions.

Protect privacy. For sensitive data, consider self-hosted open-source models like DeepSeek V4-Flash, Llama 4, or Qwen 3.5.

Human oversight is non-negotiable. Build review loops into every automated system. Cowork, by default, requires user approval before significant actions — keep it that way.

Project Glasswing & The Cybersecurity Reset

Anthropic's decision to keep Mythos Preview in a private partnership with critical infrastructure operators sets a new bar for responsible release. The model can autonomously discover and exploit zero-day vulnerabilities — capabilities that, in the wrong hands, would cause large-scale harm. The Glasswing approach (limited, defensive, time-boxed access while safeguards mature) is now the template several labs are adopting. OpenAI followed within a week with its own restricted-access cybersecurity model.

EU AI Act & Global Regulation

The EU AI Act issued its first formal enforcement inquiries in March 2026 and continued through April. Three US states passed AI transparency laws in Q1. The UK AI Safety Institute published model evaluations. Understanding AI compliance is becoming a valuable, billable skill — not a hypothetical concern.

What's Coming Next

Looking ahead from late April 2026:

Models

Grok 5: Still in training as of April 26. Q2 2026 expected (May–June). 6 trillion parameters via Mixture-of-Experts; trained on Colossus 2 (1.5 GW after April upgrade). Polymarket gives 33% probability of release by June 30. Grok 4.3 Beta is the current flagship pending the full release.

Gemini 3.5: No public timeline. Polymarket assigns low probability of April release. A Sergey-Brin-led strike team training on Google's internal codebase is reportedly producing strong coding-focused benchmarks.

GPT-5.5 Pro: Now available in API as of April 24. OpenAI's "super-app" strategy — combining ChatGPT, Codex, and a dedicated browser into one desktop application — is the next product narrative.

Claude Mythos: No public release planned. Mythos-class capabilities will arrive in future Opus models once safeguards mature; Opus 4.7 ships the first generation of those safeguards.

Infrastructure

Agent-first applications: 40% of enterprise apps with AI agents by year-end (Gartner). Cowork is the wedge.

On-device AI: Qwen 3.5 2B runs on iPhones. Apple deploying Gemini via Private Cloud Compute. DeepSeek V4-Flash quantizations expected to run on 128GB Apple Silicon laptops within weeks.

Open-source acceleration: Gap closed from 18 months (2023) to days (April 2026). DeepSeek V4 ships under MIT license at frontier-class quality.

MCP Apps everywhere: The interactive UI extension to MCP, released in January and headlined at the April Dev Summit, is the path to AI as a first-class app surface — not just a chat tab.

AI regulation: EU AI Act enforcement live. US states passing transparency laws. Compliance = valuable skill.

Jobs & The Economy

108K+ jobs cut in Q1 alone, mostly in software, support, and content roles. The 56% AI salary premium continues to widen. Bank of New York is scaling 220+ AI use cases. Nvidia chips slash GPT-5.5 inference costs by up to 35× per token. The arbitrage window for AI Generalists — between what's possible and what the market knows how to deploy — remains wide. The faster you compound, the bigger your moat.

Common Questions — FAQ

Q: Do I need to know how to code?

No. Every level is designed for non-technical people. Level 5 lets you build apps by describing what you want. Cowork specifically requires zero coding background.

Q: Which AI tool should I start with?

Pick ONE — Claude or ChatGPT — and go deep. Master the PRD method first. Depth beats breadth. Given how fast Anthropic is shipping into Office, Chrome, and desktop, Claude is now the deepest single-vendor stack a generalist can pick up.

Q: How long until I can earn from this?

People start freelancing from Level 3–4. One workflow audit = \$500–\$2,000. Full mastery takes ~2 years.

Q: Will AI replace me?

AI won't replace you. Someone who knows how to use AI will. That's the entire point of this roadmap.

Q: Which model is best in April 2026?

No single best. Claude Opus 4.7 leads agentic coding and reasoning. GPT-5.5 leads agentic computing and tool use. Gemini 3.1 Pro leads multimodal. Perplexity leads research. DeepSeek V4-Flash leads cost-efficient frontier work. Use what fits the task.

Q: What is Claude Cowork and is it worth it?

Cowork is Anthropic's agentic AI for desktop knowledge work — it handles multi-step tasks involving local files, browser, Excel, and PowerPoint without requiring code. GA on macOS and Windows since April. Yes, it's worth it for any knowledge worker on Pro or Max.

Q: Is this only for tech people?

No. Biggest opportunities are in non-tech industries — law, healthcare, real estate, education.

Q: How much will tools cost?

Start for \$0. Many free tiers (DeepSeek, NotebookLM, Gemini Free, ChatGPT Free). Pro tiers: \$20–\$100/month.

Q: What about AI safety?

AI can hallucinate, reflect biases. Always verify. Project Glasswing is the new template for responsible release of high-capability models. Human oversight is non-negotiable.

Q: What happened to Sora?

OpenAI shut down the consumer Sora app on March 24 — \$1M/day costs, declining users. Compute redirected to GPT-5.5. Kling 3.0, Veo 3.1, Runway Gen-4.5, and Seedance 2.0 remain strong.

Q: How fast is this changing?

Three frontier model launches (Claude Opus 4.7, GPT-5.5, DeepSeek V4) in eight days during April. Continuous learning is essential.

Recommended Resources & Communities

Essential Reads

Anthropic Prompt Engineering Guide

<https://docs.claude.com/en/docs/build-with-claude/prompt-engineering/overview>

Gold standard for all advanced techniques.

OpenAI Cookbook

<https://github.com/openai/openai-cookbook>

Practical examples for building with OpenAI's API.

MCP Protocol Documentation

<https://modelcontextprotocol.io>

Official docs for the universal AI connector standard.

Hugging Face

<https://huggingface.co>

The GitHub of AI. Models, datasets, and demos.

LLM Stats — Model Tracker

<https://llm-stats.com>

Real-time tracking of releases, benchmarks, pricing.

Understanding AI Newsletter

<https://understandingai.org>

Deep analysis of AI developments.

a16z Big Ideas 2026

<https://a16z.com/big-ideas-2026>

Andreessen Horowitz predictions for AI.

Latent Space Podcast

<https://latent.space>

Leading AI engineering podcast.

Simon Willison's Weblog

<https://simonwillison.net>

Best independent AI reporting; Mythos and V4 deep dives.

Anthropic News & Research

<https://www.anthropic.com/news>

Source of truth on Claude products and Glasswing.

Communities to Join

r/ChatGPT — Reddit's largest AI community

<https://reddit.com/r/ChatGPT>

r/ClaudeAI — Claude-focused discussion

<https://reddit.com/r/ClaudeAI>

r/LocalLLaMA — Open-source model enthusiasts

<https://reddit.com/r/LocalLLaMA>

r/SaaS — Micro-SaaS builders and founders

<https://reddit.com/r/SaaS>

Hacker News — Tech community

<https://news.ycombinator.com>

MCP Dev Summit Recordings (April 2026)

<https://events.linuxfoundation.org/mcp-dev-summit-north-america/>

Share This Roadmap

Know someone worried about AI taking their job? Send them this.
Share on WhatsApp, LinkedIn, or text it to a friend who needs it.

*You know the levels now.
Treat AI as the starting line.
Build on top of it.*

GIFT THIS AI MASTERMIND TO YOUR FRIENDS & COLLEAGUES

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For any questions, write to hi@outskill.com